

Fabled — Product Requirements Document

Tagline: A whimsical book club

Secondary: Discover your reading aura.

Swipe line: Swipe on books blind. Discuss with your tribe.

What It Is

A mobile-first responsive web app where readers discover their “reading aura” personality (one of 12 archetypes), form tribes with friends, swipe on AI-curated blind book descriptions, vote on what to read, and discuss with AI-generated conversation prompts.

Not a native app. No app store. Shareable via URL. Works great on phones, acceptable on desktop.

Core Loop

Generate aura → Join or create tribe → Swipe on blind book deck → Reveal matches → Vote → Read → Discuss → Repeat

Tech Stack

See `CLAUDE.md` for architecture rules. Summary:

- Next.js 14+ (App Router) — Vercel deploy
 - React + Tailwind CSS
 - Anthropic API (server-side only, model: `claude-sonnet-4-20250514`)
 - Supabase (database + auth + realtime)
 - Google Fonts (Playfair Display, DM Sans, JetBrains Mono)
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The 12 Archetypes

Full archetype data including axes, compatibility, copy, and visual direction lives in `/docs/archetypes.json` . Import and use directly — never hardcode archetype copy.

ID	Name	Reader Type
archivist	The Archivist	Layer diggers, annotators, re-readers
nocturne	The Nocturne	3am finishers, intensity addicts
wanderer	The Wanderer	Atmosphere chasers, mood readers
oracle	The Oracle	Memoir readers, self-seekers
cartographer	The Cartographer	World-builders, fantasy/sci-fi loyalists
scribe	The Scribe	Craft worshippers, prose-first readers
sentinel	The Sentinel	Adrenaline readers, plot-first
heretic	The Heretic	Genre benders, anti-canon readers
ember	The Ember	Hope-seekers, redemptive arc devotees
revenant	The Revenant	Gothic devotees, darkness dwellers
seer	The Seer	Multi-POV collectors, empathy readers
conjururer	The Conjururer	Romance devotees, connection-first readers

Reading Axes (5 Dimensions)

Rendered as sliding bars with a glowing dot. “i” button opens a description modal.

Key	Left (1)	Right (5)	Description
heartVsHead	Heart	Head	Reading to feel vs. reading to think
plotVsProse	Plot	Prose	What happens vs. how it’s written
familiarVsFrontier	Familiar	Frontier	Depth in one lane vs. exploring new territory
lightVsDark	Light	Dark	Books as refuge vs. books as confrontation

realVsImagined	Real	Imagined	This world vs. an invented one
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Compatibility Matrix

Each archetype has one best match and one creative tension pairing. Full descriptions in `archetypes.json`. Used on the full aura profile screen and member aura modal.

User Stories

Story 1: New User, No Aura

Trigger: User visits `fabled.app` for the first time, organically or via shared link.

Flow:

1. Welcome screen with Fabled branding, tagline, "Discover Your Reading Aura" CTA
2. Sign up: email + display name only. Password or magic link.
3. Enter 3-7 books they love
4. AI generates their reading aura (archetype, colors, bio, axes, all fields)
5. Full aura card with "Save My Aura" CTA
6. After saving: "Create a Tribe" or "Join a Tribe" (invite code input)
7. Neither path: home screen with aura card and empty tribes section

Edge cases:

- Arrival via invite link (`fabled.app/join/CODE`): store the tribe code, route through onboarding/aura first, then auto-join after aura is saved
 - AI call failure during aura generation: show error with retry button. Do not lose book inputs.
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Story 2: Creating a Tribe

Trigger: User taps "Create New Tribe" from home screen.

Flow:

1. Enter tribe name (max 30 characters)

2. System generates unique 6-character alphanumeric invite code (uppercase, easy to read aloud)
3. Share screen: code + shareable link (fabled.app/join/CODE) + Web Share API button
4. Returns to home with new tribe in "waiting for members" state
5. Minimum 2 members required before deck generation

Edge cases:

- Duplicate tribe names allowed (tribes identified by code, not name)
 - Creator counts as member 1
 - After 7 days with only 1 member: gentle nudge to invite friends
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Story 3: Joining a Tribe

Trigger: User receives invite code or link.

Flow:

1. Via link: opens app, shows tribe name and member count, "Join this tribe?" CTA
2. Via code: user enters code on join screen from home
3. No account yet: onboarding + aura generation first, then auto-join
4. Has aura: joins immediately
5. Existing members see real-time notification of new join

Edge cases:

- Invalid code: "This code doesn't exist. Check with whoever sent it."
 - Tribe full (12 members max): "This tribe is full."
 - Already a member: "You're already in [tribe name]."
 - User can be in up to 5 tribes
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Story 4: The Swipe Cycle

This is the most complex flow. Four phases.

Phase 4a: Deck Generation

Trigger: Any tribe member taps "Generate New Deck" (available when tribe is in `ready` state with 2+ members).

Flow:

1. AI analyzes combined reading auras of all tribe members
2. Generates 15 blind book descriptions. Each includes:
 - 2-3 sentence vibe description (no title, author, or cover). Evocative, specific, slightly playful. NO sensory metaphors (no "smells like", "feels like").
 - One genre tag
 - 2-3 mood tags
3. All members see "New Deck Ready" card on home screen
4. Tribe enters `swiping` state

AI deck composition:

- 8-9 books in the group's shared taste overlap
- 3-4 books that stretch one or two members
- 2-3 wild cards that might surprise everyone
- Never repeat a book the tribe has been previously served

Edge cases:

- New member joins mid-swipe: they get the current deck, their votes count
- Only one active deck per tribe at a time

Phase 4b: Swiping

Trigger: User opens deck from home screen.

Flow:

1. Intro screen: explains blind mechanic, shows tribe members, "Start Swiping" CTA
2. One card at a time. Swipe right = yes. Swipe left = nah. Buttons also available.
3. "YES" and "NAH" labels appear dynamically as user drags

4. Progress dots: green = yes, red = nah
5. After all 15: "Done! Waiting for your tribe..." screen
6. Waiting screen: real-time status of who's done vs. still swiping
7. Once all members done (or timeout): reveal unlocks

Edge cases:

- App closed mid-swipe: progress saved server-side. Resumes where they left off.
- 48-hour timeout from deck generation: reveal unlocks with whoever finished. Unfinished members marked "didn't vote" — their preferences don't count toward match scores.
- If only 1 member finishes after timeout: extend by 24 hours with nudge.
- Minimum 2 members must finish for reveal to be meaningful.

Phase 4c: Reveal

Trigger: All members finish swiping, or timeout.

Flow:

1. All members see "The Reveal" screen (simultaneously or when they next open app)
2. Books revealed one by one, staggered animation, sorted by match strength:
 - "Everyone loved this" — 100% voted yes
 - "Strong match" — 75%+ voted yes
 - "Split decision" — 50-74% voted yes
 - "Niche pick" — below 50%
3. Each card: book title, author, genre tag, mood tags, match score (X/Y members), who voted what
4. "Vote for Next Read" CTA after all revealed

Edge cases:

- No unanimous matches: show "Strong match" as top tier
- All niche picks: show them, let tribe vote anyway
- Tie in voting: show both, tribe discusses. Tiebreaker: most "yes" swipe votes.

Phase 4d: Voting

Trigger: Reveal screen loads.

Flow:

1. Each member taps one book as their pick for next read
 2. Real-time vote tally visible to all
 3. Once all members vote (or 24-hour timeout), winning book becomes "currently reading"
 4. Tribe transitions to `reading` state
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Story 5: Discussion Mode

Trigger: Tribe has a "currently reading" book. Any member taps "Start Discussion".

Flow:

1. Discussion screen: book info header (title, author, genre)
2. Four tabs, each with swipeable question cards:
 - **Warm Up** (3 questions) — easy starters, character preferences, first impressions
 - **Turn Up the Heat** (3 questions) — spicy, fun, unhinged, slightly provocative
 - **Go Deep** (3 questions) — philosophical, thematic, existential
 - **Hot Take** — AI-generated controversial opinion. "Another Hot Take" button generates more.
3. Questions generated by AI for the specific book
4. Navigation: tier tabs at top, arrow/dot navigation within each tier
5. Tribe member pills at bottom (all tappable to view auras)
6. Questions persist so members can reference during real-life or virtual discussions

Edge cases:

- Discussion mode available indefinitely while book is "currently reading"
- All members see the same questions (generated once, stored)
- New deck generated: current book moves to "past reads". Discussion questions stay accessible in history.

Story 6: Viewing Auras

Trigger: User taps any member name anywhere in the app.

Flow:

1. Bottom sheet slides up: creature avatar, archetype name, bio, strengths
2. "View Full Aura" link to complete profile
3. Closes on X tap or backdrop tap

Member names are tappable on every screen: home screen tribe list, swipe deck intro, waiting room, reveal screen, discussion mode tribe bar, all future screens.

Story 7: Managing Your Aura

Trigger: User taps "My Aura" in bottom nav or their aura card on home screen.

Flow:

1. Full aura card screen
 2. "Regenerate My Aura" button at bottom
 3. Warning: "This will update your aura across all your tribes. Your books will be reset." Confirm/Cancel.
 4. Regenerating returns to book input screen
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Story 8: Multiple Tribes

Trigger: User creates or joins more than one tribe.

Flow:

1. Home screen: all tribes in scrollable list, each with current state
2. Each tribe card: name, member count, status (waiting / swiping / reading), relevant CTA
3. Bottom nav "Tribes" tab: full tribe list
4. Leave tribe via tribe settings (confirm dialog)

Edge cases:

- Max 5 tribes per user
 - Leaving a tribe: in-progress votes remain. User disappears from member list. Past reveal data stays.
 - Tribe drops below 2 members: enters `empty` state, can't generate decks until someone new joins.
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Tribe State Machine

`EMPTY (< 2 members)`

→ member joins (2+ members) → `READY`

`READY (2+ members, no active deck)`

→ any member triggers "Generate Deck" → `SWIPING`

`SWIPING (deck generated)`

→ all members finish swiping → `REVEAL`

→ 48hr timeout (2+ finished) → `REVEAL`

→ 48hr timeout (< 2 finished) → extend 24hr → `REVEAL` or stay `SWIPING`

`REVEAL`

→ CTA to vote → `VOTING`

`VOTING`

→ all members vote → `READING`

→ 24hr timeout → `READING` (with votes received)

`READING (book selected, discussion available)`

→ any member triggers "Generate New Deck" → `SWIPING`

All UI derives from this state. Never infer state from other signals.

Screen Specifications

Screen 1: Welcome / Onboarding

- Fabled logo + tagline
- "Discover Your Reading Aura" CTA
- Sign up (email + display name) or sign in

- If arriving via invite link: "You've been invited to [tribe name]!" above CTA
- Clean, centered, minimal. Dark warm aesthetic.

Screen 2: Aura Generation

- Book input: text field with + button, books appear as removable pill tags
- "Reveal My Reading Aura" appears at 3+ books
- Loading screen: cycling messages + floating orb animation
- Full aura card result on completion

Screen 3: Home

- Fabled header
- Mini aura card (tappable to full aura)
- Tribe section: each tribe shows name, invite code, member pills, status, current book, CTA
- "What's Next" action cards based on tribe state
- "Create New Tribe" button
- Bottom nav: Home, Tribes, My Aura

Screen 4: Tribe Creation

- Tribe name input
- Generates invite code on submit
- Share screen: code + link + native share button
- "Done" returns to home

Screen 5: Join Tribe

- 6-character code input (auto-uppercase)
- Shows tribe preview on valid code entry
- "Join" CTA

Screen 6: Swipe Deck

- Intro screen: explains blind mechanic, shows tribe members, "Start Swiping" CTA

- Card stack: one card at a time, drag or buttons
- Each card: genre tag, mood tags, blind vibe description
- Progress dots at bottom
- YES/NAH labels on drag

Screen 7: Waiting Room

- "Waiting for your tribe..." with floating animation
- Real-time member status list (done / still swiping)
- Auto-transitions to reveal

Screen 8: Reveal

- "The Reveal" header
- Books revealed one by one, staggered animation, sorted by match tier
- Each card: title, author, genre, mood tags, match score, who voted what
- Tier headers per match percentage
- "Vote for Next Read" CTA after all revealed

Screen 9: Voting

- Book list from reveal, each with "Vote" button
- Real-time vote tally
- Voted book highlighted after casting
- Auto-resolves at 24hr timeout

Screen 10: Discussion Mode

- Book info header (title, author, genre)
- Tier selector tabs: Warm Up, Turn Up the Heat, Go Deep, Hot Take
- One question card visible at a time, swipe or arrow/dot navigation
- Hot Take: AI opinion + "Another Hot Take" button
- Tribe members bar at bottom (all tappable)

Screen 11: Full Aura Profile

- Creature illustration (SVG), archetype name, bio, strengths
- 5 reading dimension axes with info modal
- “Book Star Gods Noticed” superlative
- Compatibility: best match + creative tension with descriptions
- Swipeable bonus cards: book-scope recommendation, roast, spirit book, 2036 prediction
- If own profile: “Regenerate” button at bottom
- If other member: back button

Member Aura Modal (Global)

Slides up as overlay on any member name tap:

- Creature avatar (56px), member name, archetype, bio, strengths
- “View Full Aura” link
- Close on X or backdrop tap

AI Prompts

All prompt templates live in `/docs/AI_PROMPTS.md`. Use them verbatim. Do not paraphrase or modify prompts. All prompts instruct the model to return valid JSON only.

Three prompts:

1. Aura Generation — takes book list, returns full aura JSON
2. Deck Generation — takes tribe member auras + history, returns 15 blind book descriptions
3. Discussion Questions — takes book title + author, returns questions in four tiers

Database Schema (Supabase)

users

Column	Type	Notes
id	uuid PK	
email	text	
display_name	text	
created_at	timestamp	

auras

Column	Type	Notes
id	uuid PK	
user_id	uuid FK → users	
archetype	text	One of the 12 archetype IDs
color_primary	text	Hex color
color_secondary	text	Hex color
color_tertiary	text	Hex color
bio	text	
superlative	text	
roast	text	
strengths	jsonb	Array of 3 strings
axes	jsonb	Object with 5 integer values (1-5)
book_scope	text	
spirit_book	text	
prediction_2036	text	
books_input	jsonb	Array of strings (books they entered)
created_at	timestamp	

tribes

Column	Type	Notes
id	uuid PK	
name	text	Max 30 chars
invite_code	text unique	6-char uppercase alphanumeric
created_by	uuid FK → users	
status	enum	empty, ready, swiping, reveal, voting, reading
current_book_title	text nullable	
current_book_author	text nullable	
created_at	timestamp	

tribe_members

Column	Type	Notes
tribe_id	uuid FK → tribes	
user_id	uuid FK → users	
joined_at	timestamp	
PK	(tribe_id, user_id)	

decks

Column	Type	Notes
id	uuid PK	
tribe_id	uuid FK → tribes	
books	jsonb	Array of {title, author, genre, moodTags, vibe}
created_at	timestamp	

swipe_votes

Column	Type	Notes
deck_id	uuid FK → decks	
user_id	uuid FK → users	
book_index	integer	0-14
liked	boolean	
PK	(deck_id, user_id, book_index)	

book_votes

Column	Type	Notes
tribe_id	uuid FK → tribes	
deck_id	uuid FK → decks	
user_id	uuid FK → users	
book_index	integer	
PK	(tribe_id, deck_id, user_id)	

discussion_questions

Column	Type	Notes
id	uuid PK	
tribe_id	uuid FK → tribes	
book_title	text	
book_author	text	
warm_up	jsonb	Array of 3 strings
turn_up_the_heat	jsonb	Array of 3 strings
go_deep	jsonb	Array of 3 strings

hot_takes	jsonb	Array of 5 strings
created_at	timestamp	

tribe_book_history

Column	Type	Notes
tribe_id	uuid FK → tribes	
book_title	text	
book_author	text	
completed_at	timestamp	

API Routes

Route	Method	Purpose
/api/generate-aura	POST	Generate reading aura from book list
/api/tribes	POST	Create a new tribe
/api/tribes/join	POST	Join a tribe by invite code
/api/tribes/[id]	GET	Get tribe details + members
/api/tribes/[id]/generate-deck	POST	Generate new swipe deck
/api/tribes/[id]/swipe	POST	Submit swipe vote for a book
/api/tribes/[id]/reveal	GET	Get reveal data (match results)
/api/tribes/[id]/vote	POST	Vote for next read
/api/tribes/[id]/discussion	GET/POST	Get or generate discussion questions
/api/users/[id]/aura	GET	Get a user's aura

Deployment

- Vercel for hosting
 - Supabase for database + auth + realtime
 - `.env.example`: `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`, `NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL`,
`NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY`, `SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY`
 - README with setup instructions written for non-technical users
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MVP Scope

Build Now

- Aura generation (full feature)
- Tribe creation + join via code
- Swipe deck generation + swiping
- Reveal screen with match tiers
- Simple voting (tap to vote)
- Discussion mode with AI questions
- Member aura viewing
- Home screen with tribe state
- Mobile-responsive design
- Basic auth (email + password)

Post-MVP

- Push notifications (Web Push API)
- Tribe book history / past reads archive
- Aura comparison tool (side-by-side)
- Social sharing of aura cards (shareable image)
- Multiple deck sizes (8-book quick round, 15-book full)
- "Reading now" status (individual progress tracking)

- Desktop-optimized layout
- OAuth sign-in (Google, Apple)